BLOG HUB

BLOGGING & PUBLISHING PLATFORM

Business Requirements Document

A blog management and publishing platform for readers, authors and administrators.

Document BlogHub-BRD-001

Version v1.0

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Most publishing tools serve one role well and the others badly. Readers hit a registration wall before they can read a paragraph, authors publish into silence with no view of what a draft is doing, and moderation happens in a spreadsheet beside the product rather than inside it. Blog Hub is a single platform built around three role-scoped surfaces — public reading, author workspace, and admin moderation — over one shared content model, so growth in one surface does not degrade the others.

2. BUSINESS OBJECTIVES

- Grow readership without requiring registration, so distribution is not throttled by a sign-up step.
- Reduce the editorial cost of publishing by giving authors a review path inside the product itself.
- Keep comment quality high enough that comments can remain switched on rather than disabled to cut moderation load.
- Give the business a single system of record for content, authorship and moderation decisions.

3. STAKEHOLDERS

Stakeholder	Interest
Reader	Immediate access to the article; no account, no interruption.
Author	A place to draft, get reviewed, publish, and see what happened afterwards.
Editor / Admin	Control over what goes live and what stays in the comments.
Owner	Contributor growth and retention; predictable moderation effort.

4. CURRENT STATE

Teams at this size typically run a hosted blog plus a chat thread for review and a spreadsheet for moderation. Review decisions are invisible in the product, and moderation history exists only in whoever remembers it.

5. SCOPE

In scope

- Public reading, categories, authoring and review, comments and moderation, user and role management.

Out of scope

- Paid subscriptions and paywalls, advertising, multi-language publishing, mobile applications.

6. BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS

- BR-1 — Any published article must be fully readable by a signed-out visitor, with no account prompt or paywall.

- BR-2 — A post must move through an explicit draft → in review → published → archived lifecycle, enforced server-side.
- BR-3 — First-time commenters must be held for approval before their comment appears publicly.
- BR-4 — Every moderation action (approve, reject, role change, removal) must be attributable to an actor and a timestamp.
- BR-5 — Deleting or demoting a user must never remove their previously published content; attribution must be retained.

7. SUCCESS METRICS

- Share of article views served to signed-out readers stays high — the public promise is being kept.
- Median time from draft submitted to published decision falls against the pre-platform baseline.
- Comments removed after publication fall relative to comments handled in the moderation queue.

8. ASSUMPTIONS & CONSTRAINTS

- Content is text-first with supporting images; video is out of scope for this release.
- A single publication per account in the first release.
- Search engine visibility depends on public article URLs, so slugs must remain stable once published.

9. RISK REGISTER

Risk	Mitigation
Open comments attract spam.	First-time commenters are held for review before anything is public.
A mandatory review step becomes a publishing bottleneck.	Trusted authors can be granted direct-publish permission.
Slug changes break inbound links and search ranking.	Slugs are immutable once an article is published.
Moderator turnover loses institutional knowledge of past decisions.	Every moderation action is written to an append-only audit log.

10. ROADMAP

- **Shipped** — public reading, authoring with draft and publish states, comments, admin moderation, role-based access.
- **Next** — scheduled publishing, revision history with diffs, author-level analytics.
- **Later** — newsletter distribution, AI-assisted drafting and tag suggestions, multi-publication support under one account.